

34T ENGL – 2024

English – Solved

SECTION-A (Reading Skill: 10 Marks)

(i) Which trait explains in a single word the many qualities of A.P.J. Abdul Kalam? [1]

Ans: 4. Multifaceted.

(ii) What was so special about Kalam that no other President could do? [2]

Ans: He personally made and worked on PowerPoint presentations to explain his vision of India even to foreign dignitaries like US President George Bush and Pakistan President Musharraf, presenting complex ideas on nuclear energy and poverty alleviation so clearly that they remarked they would have to become scientists to fully understand it.

(iii) Which qualities made him loved by children? [2]

Ans: His humility, simplicity, accessibility, and his ability to give children easy-to-digest messages in a friendly, approachable manner made him greatly loved by children.

(iv) What were the bills not passed by Kalam initially? [2]

Ans: He showed visible unease before giving his consent to the Office of Profit Bill, 2006, and the ordinance on Disqualification of Elected Representatives, 2004, both of which were sent to him a second time before he finally approved them.

(v) What was his mission? [2]

Ans: His mission was to meet and interact personally with ten lakh students, a mission he pursued relentlessly and completed even after leaving Rashtrapati Bhavan.

(vi) Antonym of 'modest' [1]

Ans: Arrogant / extravagant.

SECTION-B (Advanced Writing Skills: 25 Marks)

2. Notice for Inter-College Debate Competition (50 words) [5]

NOTICE All interested students of Mayong Anchalik College are informed that an Inter-College Debate Competition on the topic 'Social Media: Boon or Bane' will be held shortly. Interested participants should register their names with the undersigned by 10th July. Don't miss this opportunity to showcase your speaking skills!
Juktiman/Juktimoni Secretary, Debate Club

OR: Advertisement for lost file folder [5]

Ans: LOST: A file folder containing important documents was lost in a bus travelling towards Lumding on [date]. Finder is requested to contact Barun/Birina at [phone number/address]. A suitable reward awaits the honest finder.

3. Report on water conservation campaign (100-125 words) [10]

Ans: SCHOOL JOINS WATER CONSERVATION DRIVE — Merryland Public School, Tezpur, recently participated in a city-wide campaign organized by various agencies to create awareness about water conservation. As part of the initiative, students and teachers took part in a rally, distributed pamphlets, and demonstrated rainwater harvesting techniques installed on the school premises. Experts were invited to speak on the importance of judicious water use and the alarming decline in groundwater levels. Students pledged to fix leaking taps at home and use water sparingly. The campaign concluded with a poster competition on water conservation. The initiative left a lasting impression on students about their responsibility towards conserving this precious natural resource.

OR: Report on exhibition-cum-sale for Helpline India (100-125 words) [10]

Ans: EXHIBITION-CUM-SALE SUPPORTS ORPHANS — Our school recently organized an exhibition-cum-sale of items handmade by students during their work experience classes. The event, displaying handicrafts, paintings

and craft items, received an overwhelming response from parents and visitors, many of whom generously purchased items. The entire proceeds from the sale were donated to Helpline India, an organization working for the welfare of orphaned children, at a special function held on the school premises. The Principal thanked all contributors and appreciated the students' creativity and spirit of generosity. The event highlighted how young students can meaningfully contribute to social causes through their own skills and effort.

4. Application with resume for Music Teacher post [10]

Ans: A formal letter from Shahnawaz/Shahnaz Siddiqui of Naobaicha addressed to the Managing Director, Regional Baghdevi College, Sipajhar, applying for the advertised post of Music Teacher, mentioning musical qualifications and teaching experience, followed by a detailed resume.

OR: Letter to the editor on e-addiction among youth [10]

Ans: A formal letter expressing concern over the gradual loss of focus and concentration among selfie-obsessed youngsters, recommending measures such as limiting screen time, promoting outdoor activities, and creating parental/school awareness programmes to curb e-addiction.

SECTION-C (Grammar: 20 Marks)

5. (a) M. Hamel said, "My children, this is the last lesson I shall give you. The order has come from Berlin to teach only German in the schools of Alsace and Lorraine." [2]

Ans: M. Hamel tenderly told his children that that was the last lesson he would give them, adding that the order had come from Berlin to teach only German in the schools of Alsace and Lorraine.

(b) Aditi asked Raju if his sister was at home. Raju replied that she was not; she had gone shopping with their mother. [2]

Ans: Aditi asked Raju, "Is your sister at home?" Raju replied, "No, she is not. She has gone shopping with our mother."

6. Change the voice (any three) [3]

Ans: (a) She likes sweets. → Sweets are liked by her. (b) The man narrated me a story. → A story was narrated to me by the man. (c) The baby is being taken care of by the maid. → The maid is taking care of the baby.

7. Correct verb forms (any five) [5]

Ans: (a) Are you going to attend the party tonight? (b) If you had gone there, you would have met the celebrities. (c) Don't linger, we are running out of time. (d) They will have finished the course by next month. (e) It snows many times every winter in Frankfurt.

8. Fill in with appropriate prepositions (any four) [4]

Ans: (a) You can place the book on the table. (b) The Second World War broke out on 1st September, 1939. (c) He is fond of chocolate. (d) Patriotism consists in the honesty of service.

9. Sentence transformation (any four) [4]

Ans: (b) If you do not study hard, you will fail. → Study hard, or you will fail. (Compound) (c) He leads a most unhappy life. → What a most unhappy life he leads! (Exclamatory) (e) Only Anita can do this. → No one except Anita can do this. (Negative) (f) Who does not wish to be happy? → Everybody wishes to be happy. (Assertive)

SECTION-D (Textbooks: 45 Marks)

10.(a) 'A Thing of Beauty' extract

Ans: (i) The name of the poem is 'A Thing of Beauty' by John Keats. (ii) The 'mighty dead' are the great, noble heroes and legendary figures of the past whose glorious deeds live on in tales and legends. (iii) The 'endless fountain of immortal drink' refers to the everlasting joy and inspiration that beautiful stories, tales and legacies of the mighty dead continuously provide to humanity. (iv) 'Brink' means edge or margin — here it refers to the edge of heaven, the source from which this joy flows down to us.

OR (b) 'A Roadside Stand' extract

Ans: (i) The new shed was put up at the edge of the road, in front of the little old house, to sell wild berries and squash and earn some money from passing motorists. (ii) The poet uses the word 'pathetic' because the roadside stand's appeal for buyers reflects the sellers' desperate, pitiable need for money. (iii) 'Too pathetically pled' means the stand seemed to plead too pitifully and helplessly for the attention and money of the passing traffic.

11. Any three (30-40 words) [6]

Ans: (i) Kamala Das's childhood fear was of losing her mother; she hid this fear behind a constant, brave smile even while feeling deep anxiety within. (ii) In 'Keeping Quiet' the poet appeals for a moment of universal stillness and introspection, free from hurry, aggression and war, so that humanity can understand itself better. (iii) The parting words and smile of the speaker signify her attempt to conceal her true sadness and fear beneath a calm, brave exterior. (iv) According to Neruda, keeping quiet would be an exotic moment because we normally never allow ourselves such stillness; being still without complete inactivity would feel strange and refreshing, offering time for genuine self-reflection. (v) Four things of beauty mentioned are: the sun, the moon, trees old and young, and clear rills (streams).

12. Any five (1 mark each)

Ans: (a) Savita is a young bangle worker mentioned in 'Lost Spring'. (b) Wachter, the blacksmith, asked Franz not to hurry to school. (c) Gandhi met Prof. J. B. Kripalani for the first time at the Lucknow Congress. (d) Gandhi met the Lieutenant-Governor twice. (e) The author discovered various species of wild birds and animals at Peacock Island. (f) Derek is Sophie's brother. (g) Sophie wanted Danny Casey's autograph for Geoff. (h) The peasants paid British landlords a share (three out of twenty parts of their land, the tinkathia system) as rent for growing indigo.

13. Any five (30-40 words each) [10]

Ans: (a) M. Hamel was dressed differently that day in his best clothes—a green coat, a frilled shirt and an embroidered black silk cap—normally reserved for inspection or prize-giving days, showing the solemnity of the occasion. (b) 'Viva la France' translates as 'Long live France'; M. Hamel wrote it on the blackboard at the end of the last lesson. (c) The title 'Lost Spring' refers to the lost childhood of poor children like Saheb and Mukesh, who are forced into labour instead of enjoying the 'spring', or carefree years, of their lives through education and play. (d) Gandhi influenced lawyers by convincing them that serving the poor was more important than earning fees; for instance, several lawyers offered to stand bail for him and followed him in his campaign in Champaran. (e) The statement 'The Battle of Champaran is won' means Gandhi succeeded in persuading the government to set up a Committee of Inquiry into the sharecroppers' grievances, marking his first victory of civil disobedience in India.

14.(a) Condition of Seemapuri (80-100 words) [5]

Ans: Seemapuri is a slum settlement on the outskirts of Delhi, home to squatters, mostly refugees from Bangladesh who arrived around 1971. The area has thousands of ragpickers living without identity, land rights, or permanent employment, yet with 'a roof over their heads' — a small comfort compared to their earlier condition. Homes are made of mud, tin and tarpaulin, lacking basic amenities like clean water and sanitation. Children like Saheb grow up scavenging garbage for a living instead of going to school, since for them garbage is literally their means of survival — 'garbage to them is gold'.

OR (b) Contrast between Jansie and Sophie [5]

Ans: Though Jansie and Sophie are of the same age and background, they are very different in temperament. Sophie is a dreamer who constantly imagines a glamorous future—owning a boutique, becoming an actress, or being noticed by footballer Danny Casey—escaping the dreariness of her working-class life through fantasy. Jansie, in contrast, is practical and realistic; she accepts her circumstances, works at a bakery like her sister, and discourages Sophie's unrealistic dreams, believing in grounded thinking rather than fanciful hopes. This contrast highlights Sophie's escapist imagination against Jansie's grounded acceptance of reality.

OR (c) Topics on the day of the last lesson [5]

Ans: On the day of the last lesson, M. Hamel covered a review of grammar rules, explaining them with unusual clarity and patience, followed by a writing lesson where students copied 'France, Alsace, France, Alsace' in beautiful round hand. He also conducted a history lesson, and made the little ones repeat their letters together, showing his effort to pack as much of the language into this final day as possible.

15.(a) Character sketch of Tiger King (125-150 words) [7]

Ans: The Tiger King, Jung Jung Bahadur, is an arrogant, superstitious and obstinate ruler of Pratibandapuram. On learning from astrologers at his birth that he would be killed by a tiger, he becomes obsessed with proving the prophecy wrong by hunting and killing tigers relentlessly, vowing not to stop until he has killed a hundred. He is autocratic, punishing anyone who dares to suggest tiger hunting is dangerous, and even marries into a state rich in tigers purely to continue his hunt. His vanity and blind faith in his own power make him ignore genuine risks; he insists on killing the hundredth tiger even after it is already wounded and old, showing his desperate pride. Ironically, it is not a real tiger but a wooden toy tiger's splinter that fatally wounds him, proving that fate cannot be outwitted by arrogance and highlighting the story's satire on the vanity of princely rulers under British rule.

OR (b) Zitkala's feelings on the first day in the land of apples [7]

Ans: On her first day in the land of apples, Zitkala-Sa felt utterly bewildered, frightened and out of place. Everything around her was unfamiliar—the bright electric lights, the rigid discipline, the strange customs like sitting on chairs and following bells for meals—all felt harsh compared to her free life on the reservation. She was deeply shaken when her friend Judewin told her that her long hair, sacred to her people, would be cut short, since among her tribe only mourners or captured enemies had their hair shingled. Terrified and humiliated, she resisted at first, hiding under a bed, but was eventually dragged out and forcibly shorn, an experience that left her feeling like one of the many little animals driven by a herder, stripped of her identity and dignity in this alien land.

16. Any four (30-40 words each) [8]

Ans: (a) Domahi is the day marking the end of Magh Bihu festivities, when cattle are bathed and worshipped as a mark of gratitude and the community feast concludes the celebrations. (b) The Kacharis observe Magh Bihu by lighting bonfires, performing the 'magan' or ritual begging, singing and dancing, and organizing communal feasting to mark the harvest. (c) There was no curtain in Mr. Lamb's house because he wanted sunlight and a full view of his beloved garden at all times, reflecting his positive, open outlook on life. (d) Yes, 'The Tiger King' is a satire that mocks the vanity, arrogance and superstition of princely rulers, as well as the flattery of the British colonial administration. (e) Bama was deeply impressed by her brother's words that people who did menial work should not be looked down upon, and that education and hard work could help overcome caste-based prejudice.